Course Outline
Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

Programme : MBA Name of the Course: **Operations Strategy** Academic Year & Term: 2026-27, 6 Course Coordinator: Prof Partha Priya Datta **Email:** IIMC id: ppdatta	
Instructor: Prof Partha Priya Datta **Affiliation:** OM Group **Email:** IIMC id: ppdatta	

Introduction to Course /Course Description

The course explores how operations can create and sustain competitive advantage. The first step in the development of an effective operations strategy is to ask: what value proposition does the firm want to offer to its customers, how does it seek to compete? The course considers a variety of possible bases of competition, including lowest price, highest quality, flexibility or speed of customer response, and innovativeness.

The choice of competitive differentiation, or industry position, will then suggest choices along critical dimensions of operating system design and management. The course provides exposure to how such an operating system must be configured so that it does what is required to deliver the chosen value proposition, or business model, most appropriately and effectively.

The course also examines the complexities associated with global operating systems, including the hidden costs of outsourcing and off-shoring. This course aims to frame key strategic operations issues and provide tools to resolve them. The cases, readings, and frameworks covered in the course are designed to serve two audiences: students who plan a career specifically in operations, and others with broader interests, but who may in the future need to analyze and improve operations for strategic purposes.

Course Objective and Key-takeaways from the course

1. Think strategically, analytically, creatively and articulate effectively
2. Formulate the steps for executing operations strategy.
3. Align Operations strategy and business strategy.

Learning Goals

1. Understand the importance of strategic operations management to ensure strategic alignment between a company's competitive environment and operations activities and ability to evaluate operations strategy. (this aligns with programme level learning goal 1 and 6)
2. Understand the key elements and decisions of strategic operations and learn how to configure the operations strategy (this aligns with programme level learning goal 1).
3. Analyze, Value and Optimize operations at a strategic level
    a. Analyze key drivers/decisions for each element of strategic operations
    b. Evaluate them qualitatively and financially
    c. Develop recommendations and implementation plans

    (this aligns with programme level learning goal 1)

Required Text Book(s) Operations Strategy by Nigel Slack and Michael Lewis; Latest Edition, Pearson Education.

Course Pack Distribution to students

Course material (Cases) will be issued from the Programme office by email or as hard copies. In addition materials/exercises/handouts for each session will be distributed by faculty individually.

Session Plan

S No.	Topic	Intended learning outcome	References
1	Linking Strategy to Operations	- Identify the drivers of strategic operations - Understand the customer's performance requirements - Define the Operations Strategy Matrix - Develop different perspectives of Operations Strategy	Chapter 1, CASE: Galanz
2-3	Competitive Priority and Trade-offs	- Understand the concepts of focus, diversification and trade-offs (multi-specialty manufacturing) - Learn to apply decision category approach and the capabilities approaches for developing operation strategy - Assess competitive threat using operations related cost advantages	Chapter 2, CASE: Inspiral
4-7	Decisions on Capacity	- Identify factors that influence capacity strategy - Assess the capacity sizing, timing, location and type decisions	Chapter 3, CASE Exercise: Acer and Segate, multiple numerical exercises
8-11	Strategic Sourcing	- Appreciate the difference between outsourcing and offshoring - Identify the drivers of outsourcing and vertical integration - Explore the supply chain relationship spectrum	Chapter 4, CASE: Adidas Speedfactory, Interior Forest Sourcing Strategy and HTC/Sun supplier selection
12-16	Process Technology, Development and Innovation	- Evaluate the process technology decisions based on the attributes, feasibility, acceptability and vulnerability - Understand the innovation and improvement process	Chapter 5, 6 CASE: Lenovo Digital SC, Namibia Diamonds, Huawei
17-18	Implementation	- Evaluate the application of different innovation/improvement processes - Learn the key factors behind operations strategy formulation and implementation - Learn the ways of turning around a failed implementation project	Chapter 7-10 CASE: Tessei
19-20	Learning	Group Presentation	

Evaluation:

Mid-Term (30%), End Term (30%), Group Presentation (30%), Class Participation (10%)